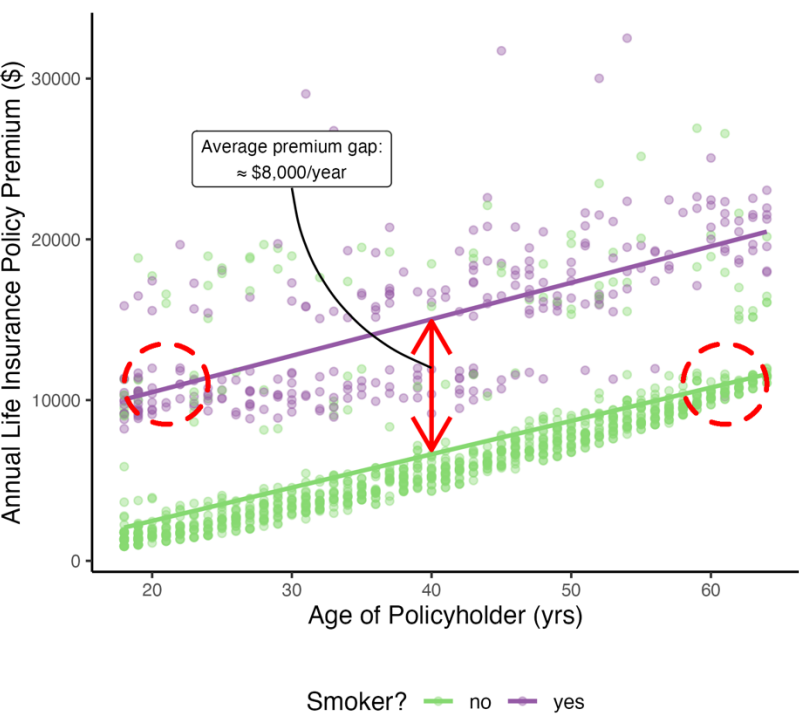


Insuring Your Life: The True Cost of Health Risk Factors

Understanding how health risk factors lead to steep life insurance premium penalties.

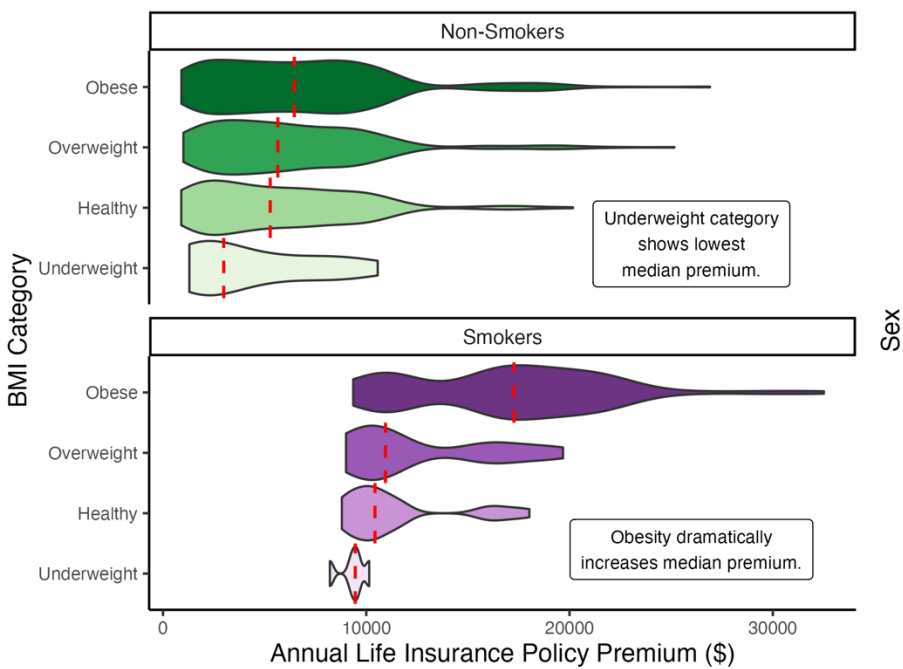
Analyzing a dataset of 1,338 life insurance policies, capturing policyholder characteristics including age, BMI, smoking status, sex, and US region.

Smoking: The Single Most Costly Risk Factor
On average, smokers pay nearly \$8,000 higher premiums at every age.



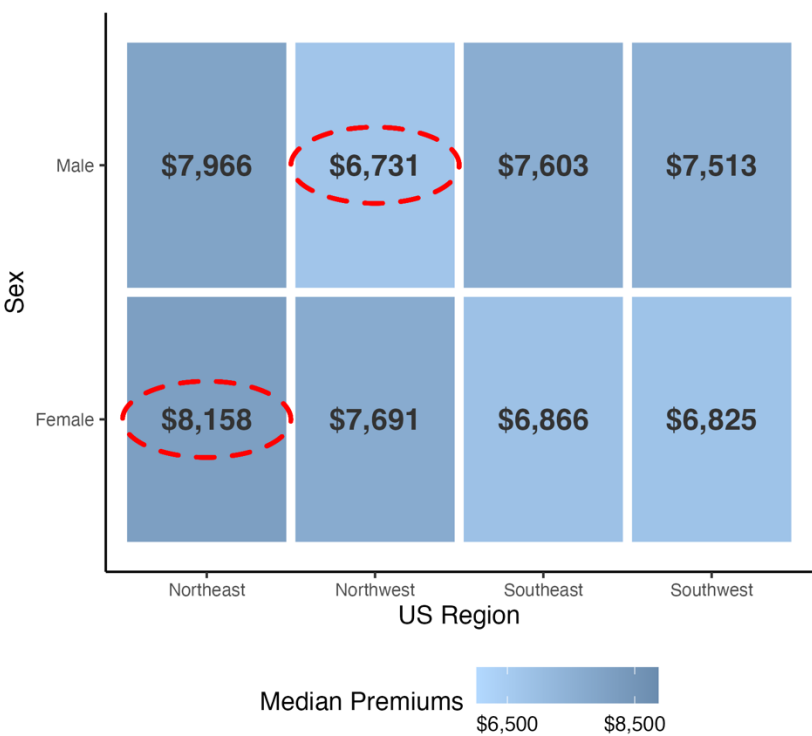
Notably, young smokers in their 20s pay similar premiums to non-smokers in their 60s, illustrating the dramatic penalty smoking carries.

Body Mass Index: Another Major Premium Driver
Obesity bumps up premiums, especially for smokers.



Red dashed lines indicate median premiums. Smoking and obesity health risks compound to make premiums skyrocket.

Region and Sex Show Modest Premium Variation
Demographic factors affect premiums, but much less than health factors.



Across sex and US region subpopulations, the highest and lowest median premiums differ by only around \$1,400 - a modest gap compared to the multi-thousand dollar increases associated with smoking and obesity.